

File Formats

Learning Objectives

- Identify common image file formats
- Compare qualities and uses of different formats
- Save files in appropriate formats for specific purposes

Engage (5-7 minutes)

When you buy rice, you choose between different packaging—gunny bags for bulk, plastic packets for retail, airtight containers for storage. Image files also need different “packaging” depending on their use. Let us learn about these digital containers.

Explore (10-12 minutes)

Create the same drawing in Paint and save it in three formats: BMP, PNG, and JPEG. Check the file sizes—notice how they differ. Now resize each to 50% and save again. Compare quality and size differences. Write your observations about which format is smallest and which is best quality.

Explain (10-12 minutes)

Common image formats serve different purposes. BMP stores every pixel but creates large files. PNG keeps quality with smaller sizes and supports transparency. JPEG compresses well for photos but loses some quality. GIF works for simple animations. Choosing the right format depends on your needs.

Elaborate (8-10 minutes)

Think about when to use each format: a school project needs high quality (PNG), a website needs small files (JPEG), a logo needs transparency (PNG), a fun animation (GIF). Create a chart matching formats to uses. Discuss why format choice matters for sharing online.

Evaluate (5-8 minutes)

Exit ticket: Name three image formats and write one use for each. Explain why JPEG files are smaller than BMP. Show how to save a file in PNG format.